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ABSTRACT

WHOSE STANDARD OF CARE? FOREIGN-GUIDELINE AND OUTDATED-VERSION DEVIATIONS OF LLMS FROM VIETNAMESE MINISTRY OF HEALTH GUIDELINES

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BACKGROUND: Large language models (LLMs) may state doses or thresholds from foreign or superseded guidelines instead of current Vietnamese Ministry of Health (MoH) guidelines; the extent and sources of such deviations are unclear.

OBJECTIVE: To pilot a method for measuring these deviations and tracing their sources.

METHODS: We analysed 61 purposively selected recommendations, quoted verbatim from 12 MoH documents in force. Comparison values were named foreign guideline values, superseded MoH values (where available) and decoys (pre-specified false values for estimating chance matches). Qwen3-8B, a small open model, answered in Vietnamese and English under three conditions: no country cue, an explicit MoH cue, or the relevant MoH passage. Answers were graded using pre-specified rules; quotations and grades were rechecked by AI only.

RESULTS: In Vietnamese with the MoH cue, for 20 recommendations differing from at least one named foreign guideline, 7 answers were correct (35.0%; 95% CI 15.4%–59.2%), 2 matched a foreign value, 7 matched no recorded source, and in 4 the rule grader could not extract a value. Among the 15 of these with a decoy, foreign versus decoy matches were 2 versus 0. For 20 other



recommendations with an older version, 3 answers matched the superseded value. With the MoH passage, 13/20 were correct (exploratory McNemar $p = 0.15$).

CONCLUSION: Most errors matched no recorded source; foreign-guideline matches were not shown to exceed the chance (decoy) level; errors remained even with the MoH passage. These results are preliminary and have not been reviewed by clinicians.

KEYWORDS: large language models; clinical practice guidelines; ministry of health; artificial intelligence; model evaluation

PRESENTATION FORMAT: Oral

TOPIC: AI and Digital Transformation in Healthcare and Medical Education

NOTE: This work has not been published in any national or international journal.